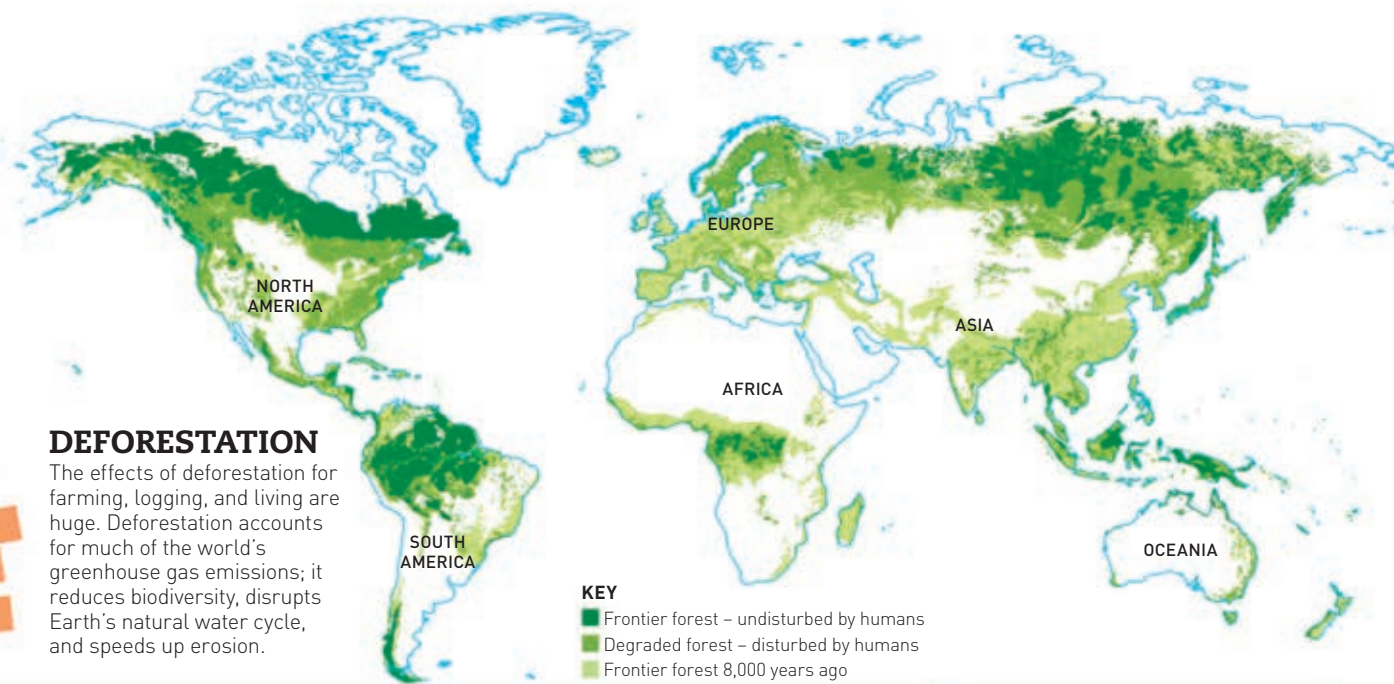




**APPROXIMATELY
18 MILLION ACRES
OF FOREST AROUND
THE WORLD ARE
DESTROYED EVERY YEAR**



DEFORESTATION

The effects of deforestation for farming, logging, and living are huge. Deforestation accounts for much of the world's greenhouse gas emissions; it reduces biodiversity, disrupts Earth's natural water cycle, and speeds up erosion.

KEY

- Frontier forest – undisturbed by humans
- Degraded forest – disturbed by humans
- Frontier forest 8,000 years ago

ENDANGERED SPECIES

Habitat loss, disease, and hunting cause hundreds, or potentially thousands, of species to become extinct every year.



PLANTS

There are more than 10,000 endangered plant species.



REPTILES

About half of all turtle species are endangered.



AMPHIBIANS

Around 43 per cent of amphibians are threatened.



BIRDS

About 13 per cent of bird species are vulnerable.



FISH

Millions of sharks are killed for their fins each year.



MAMMALS

Around 26 per cent of mammal species are threatened.

EVERYDAY CONSUMERS

There are many things people use every day that can have a big impact on the environment. Using one plastic bag in a shop might seem small, but if other people around the world do this also, the effects on the planet can be huge.



COTTON

Cotton is treated with pesticides and harmful chemicals.



BATTERIES

Batteries can release dangerous chemicals if they are not disposed of safely.



PLASTIC BAGS

Millions of marine animals die each year from swallowing plastic bags.



GADGETS

Fifty million tonnes of electrical waste is thrown out every year.



THE INTERNET

The internet produces about 300 million tonnes of carbon dioxide each year.



MEAT

Around 18 per cent of all greenhouse gas emissions comes from producing meat.



CHOCOLATE

About 25,000 litres of water is needed to make just 1 kg (2.2 lb) of chocolate.



WATER BOTTLES

Around 50 billion plastic water bottles are used each year in the USA.

OIL

Spills from tankers and oil rigs are life-threatening to sea creatures.



SHIPWRECK

Objects like sunken ships on the seabed can release harmful material from their cargo.

RECYCLING

Materials like plastic and glass can take hundreds or thousands of years to break down in a landfill site. Recycling these items can save resources and energy, while also being healthier for the environment.



PLASTIC

Plastic can be recycled into park benches, drain pipes, or even fleece jackets.



GLASS

Recycling 1 tonne of glass releases 315 kg (695 lb) less carbon dioxide than the production of new glass.



PAPER

Recycling paper uses 70 per cent less energy than producing it from raw materials.



ALUMINIUM

Recycling aluminium uses just 5 per cent of the energy needed to make new aluminium.

RENEWABLE ENERGY

Fossil fuels provide most of the world's energy, but this has serious environmental impacts and these fuels will become more scarce. There are other sources of cleaner, renewable energy that can be used instead.



WIND

Wind can power turbines that convert the wind energy into electricity.



SOLAR

Energy from the Sun is caught by solar panels and turned into electricity.



TIDAL

As tides rise and fall, they move turbines that convert the movement into energy.



HYDROELECTRIC

When water is channelled through a dam, turbines are turned, which creates energy.



GEOTHERMAL

Cool water is pumped underground through pipes, to absorb the Earth's heat.



BIOFUELS

Fuel can be produced from organic matter, like plants, which are burned to provide energy.



WOOD

Specially grown wood can be burned for heat and light. Trees must be replanted.

WAYS TO HELP THE PLANET

There are things we can all do to help reduce our impact on the planet. If everyone takes a few small steps, it can have a greatly positive effect overall.

- SWITCH OFF**
Save electricity by turning off lights and computers when they are not in use.
- TRAVEL SMART**
Try to walk, cycle, or use public transport, instead of cars.
- SAVE WATER**
Ban baths, take shorter showers, and turn off the tap when brushing teeth.
- AVOID WASTE**
Buy products with less packaging, so it is not wasted.
- RECYCLE**
Many things can be recycled, including paper, glass, and plastic.
- REUSE WASTE**
Create compost from food waste.
- DON'T LITTER**
Littering harms animals, and litter can end up in the sea, where it stays for a very long time.
- PLANT A TREE**
Trees and plants absorb carbon dioxide, a greenhouse gas.
- WATCH WHAT YOU EAT**
Buy local and seasonal food. Eat less meat.
- SPREAD THE WORD**
Encourage your friends and family to help the environment.